

Council Meeting
March 26, 2019
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Tuesday, March 26, 2019, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was reopened by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

At-Large Councilor Claire Lessard
Ward I Councilor Andrew O'Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Jeremy Zullo
At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier

Members of the Council absent were:

Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

OLD BUSINESS

Discussion of Hiring process for City Manager

Mayor Lovett gave a recap of last meeting and stated that we are here tonight to have a conference call with GovHR to see what the price would be if we did a hybrid approach.

Joellen Cademartori of GovHR stated they are a national company and feel confident that they would be the right company for the city. They have worked in 32 states and have a wide network and have many repeat customers.

Mayor Lovett asked why the hybrid approach is only \$3,000 less than the full scope recruitment.

Ms. Cademartori stated the major difference is GovHR would not be on the premises during the interview process, do not give the two-year guarantee and we would not be helping with the contract negotiations. She also mentioned that the full recruitment scope is \$500.00 less than what the bid says on the advertising line.

Conference call ended

Mr. O'Hearne asked if Jeff Barrette could speak to give us a different outlook.

Jeff Barrette, Ward 1 also a County Commissioner, Mr. O'Hearne had reached out to me to ask what we did for our hiring process at the county level. We have never used a firm, we worked with Primex for consulting services, which Claremont is a member of. Primex has a lot of tools to get the board together and help determine what kind of candidate you are looking for. They know where to advertise and help you conduct the interviews. They have the ability to do disc assessment, which is a personality test. This is a service that comes with your Risk Management payment. The county found it very valuable and we have had good luck with our candidates.

He further stated their committee included peers, 3 County Commissioners, Sheriff, County Attorney and higher-level department heads. With the search taking 2-3 months.

Mayor Lovett asked if their advertising was nationwide.

Mr. Barrette stated they used ICMA, which does advertise nationwide. The county probably spent about \$2,500 on advertising.

Mr. Stone asked how many county managers they have been thru in the last 10 years – 3 in the last 10 years.

Mr. Zullo said last time we used a search firm and it didn't work out. I think we should consider doing it with a board and using Primex.

Ms. Kier disagrees, and is in favor of hiring GovHR.

Mr. Stone said this council is ultimately responsible for the hiring and firing of the city manager.

Mr. Zullo stated at the end of the day this council has to make the decision of who are going to hire, we don't have to spend \$20,000.

Mr. O'Hearne stated he believes this council can do this.

Ms. Lessard stated last meeting I said we should change our ways of doing things, this would be perfect for us to work together.

Mr. Stone said that Wolfeboro is looking for another manager as they fired theirs' around the same time we did. They are doing the search themselves because they were unhappy with the results of MRI in regards to the last hiring. Their summer population is 14,000 and their budget is \$10 Million more than ours.

Mayor Lovett state she has a couple of concerns, if the council goes forward with doing it ourselves, who here is able to commit to this, which will be a big commitment. Councilors are already asked to do a lot and most of you have fulltime jobs.

Mr. Koloski stated, by way of Mayor Lovett, that he is good with which ever will give us the national reach and from keeping a small group of people making the decision.

Mr. Pope stated, also by way of Mayor Lovett, he is good with either the full or hybrid search, leaning more towards the full search.

Mr. Joe Osgood, Ward 1, feels that Commissioner Barrette is very community oriented, maybe he would be willing to help with this and maybe be on the committee if the council goes in that direction.

Ms. Kier noted they all received an email from resident Tom Rock, that he is in favor of hiring a firm with experience.

Mayor Lovett said if the council is ok with her speaking with Primex, the Interim City Manager and Commissioner Jeff Barrette to make sure we have the resources to be able to handle the search, she can report back at tomorrow night's meeting.

All were in favor.

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:20 p.m. a motion was made by Mr. O'Hearne and seconded by Mr. Zullo to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 6-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Gwendolyn R. Melcher
City Clerk